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Did Dave Carroll lose United Airlines \$180m?

That depends who you ask

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By The Economist | LONDON

UNITED AIRLINES has tried to draw a line under [Guitar-gate](#) by paying for repairs to Dave Carroll's damaged instrument, and offering him \$1,200-worth of flight vouchers. Mr Carroll, a musician, has told the airline to give the money to charity.

You may remember that Mr Carroll's guitar was apparently rendered unuseable as a result of rough handling during a United flight last year. He tried and failed to get recompense from the carrier, and finally decided to have his revenge by writing a song. That tune, "[United Breaks Guitars](#)", has had over 3.6m hits on YouTube.

Gulliver particularly enjoyed the *Daily Mail*'s [angle](#):

When airlines damage or lose their passenger's luggage, they normally - perhaps grudgingly - end up paying back compensation of a few hundred pounds. But United Airlines are much more out of pocket in this case. The company has lost 10 per cent of their share value - a massive \$180million - after being blamed for damaging a musician's guitar.

That's right, folks. United's share-price plunge is all attributable to Dave Carroll.

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